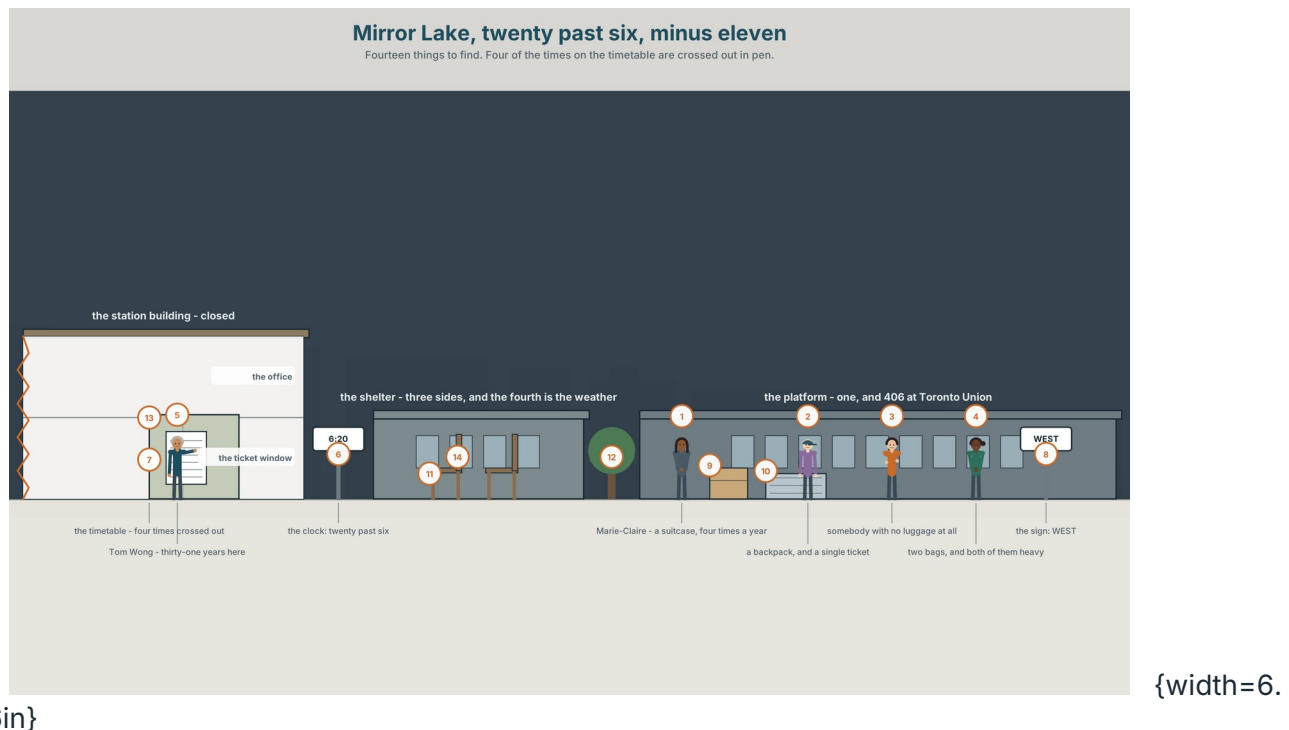


Table of Contents

A1.2 • Unit 2 • Forty Seconds at Mirror Lake

English Animated • *Getting Around* • The Prairie Line, Toronto to Vancouver Student's Book
pages 28–49 • 22 pp • ~9 hours

Part 0 • The Big Picture ♦ A • THE WORLD



Mirror Lake, twenty past six, minus eleven — Fourteen things to find. Four of the times on the timetable are crossed out in pen.

Why do people leave a place?

By the end of this unit you can ask somebody about a journey they made, and say what did not happen.

♦ A • THE WORLD

♦ B • THE SYSTEM

A station where the train stops for forty seconds and the town has lost two thirds of itself

past simple negatives and questions •
22 words for journeys and stations •
ago and the words that place a story in time • *did you* as one sound

◆ A • THE WORLD

A station where the train stops for forty seconds and the town has lost two thirds of itself

◆ C • THE PERFORMANCE

You interview somebody about a journey and find the part they left out

0A • Find it — fourteen things

Find these in the picture. Write the number.

☐ a platform ☐ a suitcase ☐ a backpack ☐ a timetable ☐ a window ☐ a lamp ☐ a bench ☐ a shelter ☐ a door ☐ a clock ☐ a sign ☐ a bag ☐ a rail ☐ a light

Three of these words are not in the picture. Which three?

an aisle · a ticket · the guard

0B • Guess it

Look at the four people waiting. **Which of them is coming back?** Say one thing. You can use these words:

bag · heavy · wait · far · single

0C • Say it

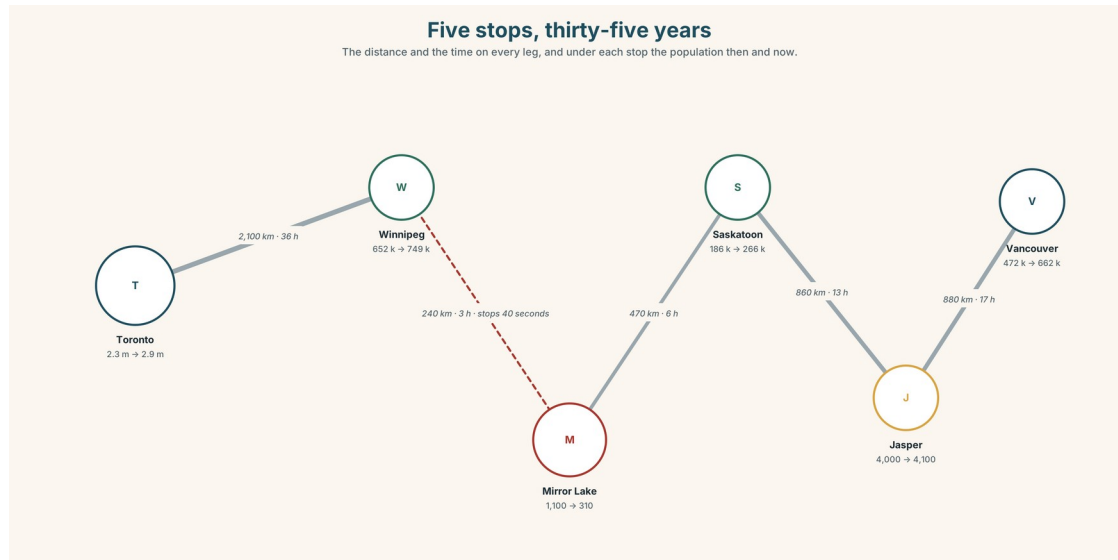
Record. Thirty seconds. Do not prepare.

Tell me about a journey you made. Where did you go, and when?

You will listen to this again on the last page.

Part 1 • Vocabulary Lab 1 ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

1A • Meet — the line, and the places on it



{width=6.

6in}

Five stops, thirty-five years — The distance and the time on every leg, and under each stop the population then and now.

journey	Four nights. Four thousand four hundred kilometres.
platform	One, at Mirror Lake. Four hundred and six at Toronto Union.
timetable	Two columns: one going west, one going east. Four times crossed out in pen.
single	Cheaper, and it says something about you.
return	Dearer, and it says something else.
guard	The person who decides whether the train waits for you.

1B • Meet — the words

journey • trip • platform • luggage • suitcase • backpack • timetable • return • single • window
• aisle • heavy • far • wait • slow • guard

Write each word under the right picture.

the office, upstairs

closed in 2009 · the window is boarded

the waiting room

locked · the timetable is on the outside wall now

the shelter

three sides · two benches · one lamp

the platform

suitcase · backpack · luggage · and forty seconds

Nobody has been up here since the school closed

Locked, and the key is in Winnipeg

The only part of the station that is still a station

Forty seconds, twice a week, each way

One station, in section

Eleven things. Eleven words. Only two of the four layers are ever used now.

{width=6.6in}

6in}

One station, in section — Eleven things. Eleven words. Only two of the four layers are ever used now.

1C • Sort — the place, or the thing you carry?

Put each word in the right box. **Two of them can go in both. Which two, and why?**

platform · suitcase · timetable · backpack · aisle · luggage · window · ticket · shelter · seat

PART OF THE STATION OR TRAIN	SOMETHING YOU CARRY	BOTH
---------------------------------	------------------------	------

1D • What happens on a journey

miss the train	Forty seconds is the difference between this and not this.
change trains	Twice on this route, and the second one is the one people get wrong.
book a ticket	Three weeks ahead it is sixty dollars. On the day it is two hundred.
a return ticket	Two journeys, one piece of paper, and a date you have to guess.
set off	Not the same as <i>leave</i> . You set off on a journey; you leave a place.
pick up	What the train does at Mirror Lake, in forty seconds.

Now say them. Two of these six could be done without going anywhere. **Which two, and what does that tell you about where the work is?**

1E • Stretch — the phrases you will need today

miss the train · change trains · book a ticket · set off · pick up

Match each phrase to the moment you need it.

1. It is three weeks before the journey and you are at a screen. → _____
2. You are on the platform and the lights are going away from you. → _____
3. It is twenty past six and you close your front door. → _____
4. The train stops for forty seconds and you are the reason. → _____
5. You arrive at Winnipeg and this is not your train. → _____

1F • The hard one

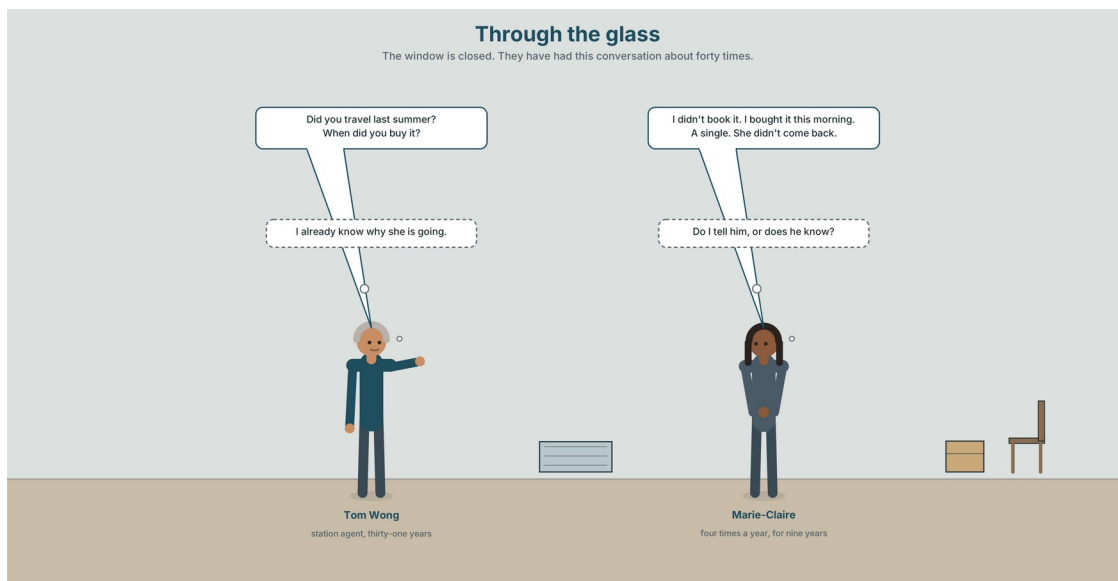
f It was ages ago.

Practise it three times. **Four words that refuse to give a date, politely.**

1G • Own it

Write down one journey you made and three things about it: when, how long, and one thing that went wrong. Do not write your name. The class guesses whose journey it is.

Part 2 • Listening ♦ A • THE WORLD



6in}

Through the glass — The window is closed. They have had this conversation about forty times.

2A • The ticket window 📻 Track 2.1

Before you listen. Marie-Claire takes this train four times a year. **Guess: is she buying a single or a return?**

Listen once. One question. How long ago did she last travel?

Listen again. Complete the table.

	Last journey	This journey
where to		

single or return

how long ago

Listen again. True or false?

1. She bought a return ticket. ☐ T ☐ F
2. She didn't book in advance. ☐ T ☐ F
3. She travelled last summer. ☐ T ☐ F
4. Tom didn't know she was coming. ☐ T ☐ F

Noticing. Four sentences from the recording.

1. *I didn't book it.*
2. *Did you travel last summer?*
3. *She didn't come back.*
4. *When did you buy it?*

Every verb after *did* and *didn't* is plain. What has happened to the past?

2B • Decoding clinic **Track 2.2**

Twenty seconds of Tom at speed. Three jobs.

1. Count how many questions he asks.
2. *Did you* is two words and he says it as one. Write what you hear.
3. He says one time marker three times. Which one, and is it a date?

Transcripts, page 149.

Part 3 • Grammar Lab 1 **B • THE SYSTEM**

Saying it did not happen, and asking whether it did

3A • Notice

Look at the four sentences in Part 2 again.

1. What word carries the past in sentences 1 and 3?
2. What is the form of the verb after it?
3. In sentences 2 and 4, where does *did* stand?
4. What happens to a question word, if there is one?

3B • See

One weight, and it moves to the front

In the positive the past sits on the verb. In a question it has moved onto did.

POSITIVE

You

bought

the ticket

↑ the past is marked once, and did takes it when did is there

QUESTION

Did

you

buy

the ticket ?

Did and didn't are the same for every person - did I, did you, did she, did they. The verb after them is the plain dictionary form, including irregular verbs: Did you go, never Did you went.

{width=6.6in}

6in}

One weight, and it moves to the front — In the positive the past sits on the verb. In a question it has moved onto did.

3C • Know

positive	the past is on the verb	<i>I booked it. She came back.</i>
negative	<i>didn't</i> + the plain verb	<i>I didn't book it. She didn't come back.</i>
question	<i>did</i> at the front, plain verb	<i>Did you book it? Did she come back?</i>
question word first	<i>when · where · why · how long</i>	<i>When did you buy it? Why did she leave?</i>

Did is the same for everybody. No *s*, no *was*, no change at all: *did I, did you, did she, did they*. It is the simplest helper in the language and it is doing all the work.

Counting backwards from now

Ago measures. The other markers name. They are two different jobs.

a long time ago

refuses to give a number, on purpose

the day before

before a day that was already in the past

last summer

names a season that has finished

last night

names a time - no the, no on

two days ago

the number comes first

NOW

{width=6.6in}

6in}

Counting backwards from now — Ago measures. The other markers name. They are two different jobs.

counting back from now	two days ago · a long time ago · How long ago?
naming a past time	last night · last summer · yesterday
before a past time	the day before
vague on purpose	recently · earlier · later · It was ages ago.

Why it matters. Almost every question anybody asks about the past is one of these four shapes, and the answer is almost always a time marker.

3D • Use — controlled

Complete with **did**, **didn't**, or the past of the verb.

I (1) _____ (buy) the ticket three weeks ago. I (2) _____ book the return — I only wanted a single. (3) _____ you travel last summer? — No, I (4) _____. I (5) _____ (come) in March. Why (6) _____ she leave?

3E • Use — guided

Make each sentence negative, then make it a question.

1. She booked a return ticket.
2. They set off at six.
3. He missed the train.
4. We changed at Winnipeg.
5. The guard waited.

3F • Use — open

In pairs. Ask your partner about a journey. **Eight questions, all with *did*, and four of them must start with a question word.**

3G • Check — six items, mark your own

1. I _____ book the return. (*negative*)
2. _____ you travel last summer?
3. When _____ you buy it?
4. She _____ come back. (*negative*)
5. × *Did you bought it?* → correct it.
6. × *I didn't went.* → correct it.

The past marked twice, again

✗ Did you bought it?

bought - and did is already past

Did

Did is the past of do. Once it is at the front of the sentence, the listener knows when this happened before they reach the verb at all. Marking it again is the same error as Does she checks, one unit of the last book, in a new costume.

✓ Did you buy it?

buy - plain, and that is not a present tense

Did

The bare form after did is not the present. It is the dictionary form, which English uses whenever a helper has already said when. The same applies after didn't: I didn't buy it, never I didn't bought it.

What the writer thought:
Irregular verbs make this worse, because bought feels like a different word rather than an ending - so it does not feel like doubling up. It is. Buy and bought are the same verb wearing two labels, and only one label is allowed.

{width=6.

6in}

The past marked twice, again — The past marked twice, again

0-3 → Workbook pp. 8-11. **4-5** → Part 6. **6** → page 46.

Part 4 • Speaking ◆ **C • THE PERFORMANCE**

4A • Fluency starter — twenty questions, all past

One person thinks of a journey. The class asks questions with *did*. **No question may be repeated, and nobody may ask the same question word twice in a row.**

4B • The functional core — asking about a past trip

Two interviews, one traveller
Four questions each. One of the two found out why she was going.

four facts

Did you? • yes • no • yes • a single

four questions

Why? • How long? • and a story about a daughter

Find the six. Which set of questions produced a story, and what kind of word does every one of them start with?

6 differences — find them all

{width=6.

6in}

Two interviews, one traveller — Four questions each. One of the two found out why she was going.

Language Bank

opening	<i>Did you travel this year? · Have you been far?</i>
the facts	<i>When did you go? Where did you go? How long did it take?</i>
the story	<i>Why did you go? What did you do there? Did you want to come back?</i>
the time marker	<i>two days ago · last summer · a long time ago · How long ago?</i>

Information gap. Learner A has the timetable as printed. Learner B has the timetable as it actually runs. **Find the four times that no longer exist.**

4C • The performance — the interview

Interview a classmate about a journey they made. **Three minutes.** You must:

ask six questions with *did* · ask one that starts with *why* · find out one thing they did **not** do · end with a time marker

Then report it in three sentences. **Record it.**

4D • Observer

One person listens for **one thing**: did anybody put a past verb after *did*?

4E • Two criteria

☐ Were all my verbs after *did* and *didn't* plain? ☐ Did I find out something that was not in the first answer?

Part 5 • Reading A • THE WORLD

5A • Predict

The title is "**One thousand one hundred, and three hundred and ten.**" What do you think the two numbers are?

5B • Read — sixty seconds

One thousand one hundred, and three hundred and ten

In 1991 Mirror Lake had one thousand one hundred people, a school with four classes, two shops and a grain elevator.

It has three hundred and ten people now. The school closed in 2009. One shop is left and it opens four days a week.

Nobody made a decision. There was no closing, no announcement and no day on which the town got smaller. Children finished school and did not come back, and nobody who left said they were leaving for good. They said they were going to Winnipeg for a year.

Tom Wong has been the station agent for thirty-one years. He did not leave. He says he never decided to stay either, and that in a place like this those are the same thing.

The train stops for forty seconds. Last year it picked up five hundred and eleven people and put down four hundred and ninety-six.

5C • Answer

1. How many people lived in Mirror Lake in 1991?
2. When did the school close?
3. How long has Tom been the station agent?
4. How long does the train stop for?
5. **Why does the writer say nobody made a decision?**
6. **The train picked up fifteen more people than it put down. What does that number mean?**

5D • Vocabulary in context

Guess from the text. Then check.

a grain elevator · for good · in a place like this · put down · the same thing

5E • The counter-text

The timetable on the station wall
Two columns, seven days, and four times crossed out in pen.

PRAIRIE LINE - MIRROR LAKE - TIMETABLE		
WESTBOUND		
DAY	ARR	STATUS
MONDAY	06.24	RUNS
TUESDAY	06.24	CROSSED OUT
THURSDAY	06.24	RUNS
SATURDAY	06.24	CROSSED OUT

EASTBOUND		
DAY	ARR	STATUS
MONDAY	21.08	CROSSED OUT
WEDNESDAY	21.08	RUNS
FRIDAY	21.08	CROSSED OUT
SUNDAY	21.08	RUNS

Date written in pen	04 / 11
Trains a week now	4
Trains a week before	8

AND AT THE BOTTOM, PRINTED:
"Winter: this stop is by request only. Requests must be made at least 12 hours in advance." Printed, not written - so it was in the design, not added later.

Two of the four westbound times are gone

Two of the four eastbound ones too - the service halved

The fourth of November, and no year

Eight became four, and nobody printed a new timetable

Printed, so somebody decided this before the sign was made

{width=6.6in}

The timetable on the station wall — Two columns, seven days, and four times crossed out in pen.

Read the timetable and answer.

1. How many trains a week stop at Mirror Lake going west?
2. **How many used to, and how do you know?**

- What is the date written beside one of the crossings-out?
- The line at the bottom is printed. What does that tell you about when it was decided?**

5F • Two texts

The reading says nobody made a decision. The timetable has four times crossed out and one printed line about winter.

Was a decision made? Say one sentence.

Part 6 • Vocabulary Lab 2 ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

Putting a story in time

One view, six times
The same view from the platform. Each panel has one thing fewer in it.

1 1991 - 1,100 people, a school, two shops

2 2001 - one shop closes

3 2009 - the school closes

4 2015 - the station office closes

5 last summer - 310 people

6 this morning - four people on the platform

6in}

{width=6.

One view, six times — The same view from the platform. Each panel has one thing fewer in it.

6A • The ones that catch everybody

ago

counts backwards from now, and it goes **after** the number: *two days ago*

last night

no *the*, and no *on*

the day before

before a moment that is already in the past, not before now

recently

near to now, and deliberately vague

6B • Say them

ago • last • yesterday • recently • earlier • later • two days ago • last night • last summer

6C • Chunk

- two days _____ — counting back from now

2. _____ night — and no *the*
3. _____ summer — a season that has finished
4. the day _____ — before a day that was already in the past
5. a long time _____ — and you are not going to say how long
6. **How long _____ ?** — the question that asks for a number

6D • Contrast Clinic

Six items. **ago** or **last**?

1. two days _____
2. _____ night
3. a long time _____
4. _____ summer
5. three years _____
6. _____ week

Part 7 • Pronunciation & Fluency Lab ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

Two words that became one

Two words that became one		
The d and the y collide and make a new sound. This is not lazy speech. It is the speech.		
did you	→	didja
		the commonest two words in any question about the past
what did you	→	whaddja
		three words, one beat
did he	→	didee
		the h disappears completely
did it	→	didit
		and this one survives intact
how long ago	→	howlongago
		no collisions at all - say it slowly and you will still sound natural

{width=6.

6in}

Two words that became one — The d and the y collide and make a new sound. This is not lazy speech. It is the speech.

7A • Hear

did you → *didja* · **what did you** → *whaddja* · **did he** → *didee* · **did it** → *didit* The d and the y collide and make a new sound. This is not lazy speech. It is the speech.

7B • Say

Say each one three times. Then say this:

What did you do, and why didn't you tell me? — nine words, four beats.

7C • Make it mean something

Say these two:

Did you go? — *didja go* · a real question *You went?* — *you went* · surprise, and you already know the answer

Same information, two different jobs. Which one is asking and which one is reacting?

7D • Fluency 20

Twenty seconds: **six questions about one journey, all with *did*.** Three times, faster.

Part 8 • Writing C • THE PERFORMANCE

A journey • 50–70 words

8A • Read the model

I went to Winnipeg three years ago, for a year. [where, when, and how long – all in nine words]

I didn't want to go. I didn't have a job here. [two negatives, and they are the reason]

I stayed for seven years. I came back last summer, for a week, and then I didn't leave. [the number that contradicts the plan]

Nobody asked me why I came back. That is why I stayed. [the sentence that is actually about the town]

Questions about the writer's choices:

1. The second line is two negatives. **Why are they more informative than a positive?**
2. *I stayed for seven years.* **What does that do to the word *a year* in line one?**
3. The last line is about other people. **Why end there?**

8B • The anti-model

I went to Winnipeg. I lived there for seven years. Then I came back. It is a nice town. I am happy here.

Correct English, and it could be anybody. **Add two negatives, one number that contradicts a plan, and one thing somebody else did.**

8C • Plan

where, when, how long → two things you did not do → the number that broke the plan → one sentence about somebody else

8D • Write — 50 to 70 words

8E • Peer review — two things only

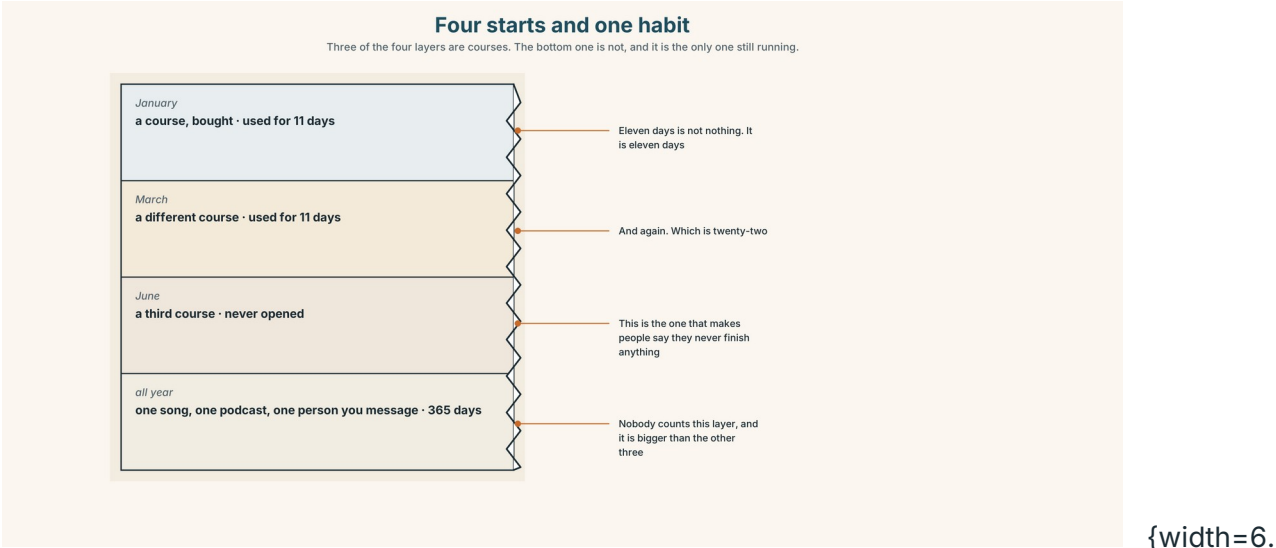
☐ Are there at least two negatives, and are the verbs after *didn't* plain? ☐ Is there a time marker in the first sentence?

8F • Publish

On the wall, with no names. **The class guesses which journeys were planned and which were not.**

Part 9 • The File ♦ A • THE WORLD + C • THE PERFORMANCE

STUDY FILE • The things you did not do



6in}

Four starts and one habit — Three of the four layers are courses. The bottom one is not, and it is the only one still running.

9A • Four starts and one habit

1

January - a course is bought

2

Days 1 to 11 - it works

3

Day 12 - nothing

4

March - a different course

5

Days 1 to 11 - exactly the same

Eleven days, twice

Five panels. The fifth is identical to the second, and that is the finding.

6in}

Eleven days, twice — Five panels. The fifth is identical to the second, and that is the finding.

What people count	the courses they bought
What counts	the eleven days, four times over — which is forty-four days
What they say	<i>I never finish anything.</i>
What is true	they did forty-four days and gave themselves credit for none of them

9B • Count the days, not the finishes

Write down every English thing you started this year and how many days you did it. Add the days up. That number is yours and nobody has ever told you it exists.

9C • Role play — the interview about last year

In pairs. Ask your partner eight questions about their English last year, all with *did*. **Four of them must be negative questions: *Didn't you...?*** Find one thing they did and have forgotten.

9D • The thing you did not stop

Everybody has one: a podcast, a song, a game, a person they message. **Name yours.** It has probably been running longer than any course you ever bought.

9E • Transfer — before next week

Write down, for seven days, one English thing you did and one you did not do. Bring both lists. The second one is the more interesting.

Part 10 • Mediation & Interaction ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE



{width=6.

6in}

Mirror Lake, thirty-five years — The services band falls before the population band, not after it.

10A • Relay

Half the class has the population figures. Half has the timetable. **Build the thirty-five years by speaking.** Ten minutes.

10B • Simplify — for one person

Somebody is thinking of moving to a small town. They ask: *What happened to Mirror Lake?* **Answer in four sentences.** Do not make it sad and do not make it a warning.

10C • Online

Write **one message** asking a friend about a trip they made. **Three sentences.** Two questions with *did*, one with a question word.

10D • Your language

Does your language have a word like *ago*? **Say two days ago in your language.** Does the number come before or after it?

Part 11 • The Decision ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE

Forty seconds

The train stops at Mirror Lake for forty seconds, twice a week each way.

Last year it picked up five hundred and eleven people and put down four hundred and ninety-six. That is about one and a half people per stop. The stop costs the company about eleven thousand dollars a year in fuel and time.

Option one: keep it. One and a half people is one and a half people, and three hundred and ten of them have no other way out.

Option two: make it request-only all year. The train stops if somebody books. In winter this is already the rule, and in winter about a third of the requests are not seen in time.

Option three: close it. The nearest other stop is a hundred and forty kilometres away.

11A • The evidence

The platform at twenty past six
The scheduled stop on the left. The winter request stop on the right.

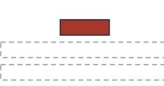
the scheduled stop

4 people · 3 bags · lamp on · the train stops



the winter request stop

1 person · 1 bag · lamp off · the train goes past



Find the six. One of them is on the station wall, and it is the reason the right-hand picture looks like that.
 6 differences — find them all

6in}

The platform at twenty past six — The scheduled stop on the left. The winter request stop on the right.

 **Track 2.6.** Tom Wong, 20 seconds: "Forty seconds. I know what it costs them. I also know that the day it stops, nobody will come here who didn't already live here, ever again."

11B • Talk about it

In threes. Use the frame. Everybody says one.

I think the company should _____, because _____.

Words you can use: journey · platform · timetable · far · wait · slow · return

11C • Decide

Write **two sentences**. Choose, and say why.

I think the company should _____, because _____.

11D • Model decision

Keep the scheduled stop and fix the request system, which is the part that is actually broken. A third of winter requests are not seen in time, and that is a number about a piece of software, not about a town.

11E • The Reveal

What happened. The company kept the stop and moved the request system to a telephone number that rings in the guard's van. Missed requests fell from a third to almost none.

Then something nobody expected: the number of people getting on rose by eleven per cent in the first year, because people who had assumed the train no longer stopped found out that it did.

One question. You do not have to answer it out loud.

The stop had not changed for four years. What had?

Part 12 • Landing ♦ all three lines

12A • Recycle — twelve items

1. I _____ book the return. (*negative*)
2. _____ you travel last summer?
3. When _____ you buy it?
4. two days _____
5. _____ night
6. _____ summer
7. the day _____
8. a long time _____
9. I need to _____ at Winnipeg. (*two words — leave one train for another*)
10. We _____ at six in the morning. (*two words — begin a journey*)
11. (*Unit 1*) We _____ (leave) at eleven.
12. (*Unit 1*) _____ that, nobody said anything.

12B • Consolidate — one task, everything in it

Write about a journey somebody else made, in six sentences. Two negatives, one question you asked them, one time marker in the first sentence, and one thing that did not go to plan.

12C • Can-do, with evidence

☐ I can ask about a past journey. **Evidence:** 4C ☐ I can say what did not happen. **Evidence:** 3G, 8D ☐ I can use *ago* and the other time markers. **Evidence:** 6D ☐ I can hear and say *did you* as one sound. **Evidence:** 7C

12D • Replay 🟡

Record 0C again. **Listen to both.** What is different?

12E • Glossary — thirty-five words, as a map

THE JOURNEY · journey · trip · far · slow · wait **THE PLACE** · platform · timetable · window · aisle · guard **WHAT YOU CARRY** · luggage · suitcase · backpack · heavy **THE TICKET** · return · single · book a ticket · a return ticket **WHAT HAPPENS** · miss the train · change trains · set off · pick up **WHEN** · ago · last · yesterday · recently · earlier · later **WHEN, IN WORDS** · two days ago · last night · last summer · the day before · a long time ago **ASKING** · How long ago? · It was ages ago.

12F • Next

Unit 3 • Is cheaper always better?